

Wei Li

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Water-Energy-Food Nexus, General Equilibrium Model, Environmental Economics, Energy Economics, Agricultural Economics, Applied Econometrics

EDUCATION

09/2021-expected 5/2027	Ph.D. in Economics , Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, the Netherlands Supervisors: Prof. Philip Ward Institute for Environmental Studies, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam; Deltares philip.ward@vu.nl Dr. Lia van Wesenbeeck School of Business and Economics, Amsterdam Centre for World Food Studies, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam c.f.a.van.wesenbeeck@vu.nl
09/2021-present	Research Associate , Amsterdam Centre for World Food Studies, the Netherlands
09/2018-07/2021	MSc. in Management , Renmin University of China, China - Graduated with distinction, ranked 1 st in cohort Supervisor: Prof Xiaohui Tian
09/2014-07/2018	BSc. in Management , Northwest Agricultural & Forestry University, China - Graduated with distinction, ranked 1 st in cohort
07/2016-08/2016	Study Abroad Program on agricultural operations and natural resource management in the US Midwest, Michigan State University, United States of America

PUBLICATIONS

Journal Articles

- Wei Li*, Philip Ward & Lia van Wesenbeeck (2025). [A critical review of quantifying water-energy-food nexus interactions](#). *Renewable and Sustainable Energy Reviews*, 211, 115280. (Impact Factor: 16.3). Cited: 22 (Jun 2026).
- Xiaohui Tian, Wei Li & Rong Li* (2021). [The environmental effects of agricultural mechanization: Evidence from agricultural machinery purchase subsidy policy](#). *Chinese Rural Economy* (中国农村经济), (9), 95-109. Cited: 74 (Jun 2026).

Invited Book Chapters

- Lia van Wesenbeeck*, Ben Sonneveld & Wei Li (2026). [Food, Water and Energy](#). In: *Encyclopedia of the Anthropocene*. Springer, Cham.

UNDER REVIEW

Wei Li*, Philip Ward & Lia van Wesenbeeck (2026). [Towards an ideal water-energy-food nexus model: moving beyond silos to integrated resource governance](#). EGU sphere [preprint]. *Hydrology and Earth System Science* (Impact Factor: 5.8).

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Wei Li*, Philip Ward & Lia van Wesenbeeck (2026). Evaluating a decade of integrated governance: welfare and equity impacts of China's Beijing-Tianjin-Hebei coordinated development plan.
- **Policy context:** Assesses the welfare and equity outcomes of China's national strategy for cross-regional coordination proposed in 2015, which aims to relieve pressure on the capital Beijing and promote balanced growth across northern China.
 - **Methodology:** Develops a social welfare optimization model with interconnected resource balance constraints, calibrated with monthly data (2022-2023) across Beijing, Tianjin, and Hebei. Simulates three categories of governance scenarios: siloed (sector & region independently), prioritized (sector/region-prioritized), and holistic (equity-oriented).
 - **Key contribution:** Provides the first quantitative evidence on how a decade of integrated governance has reshaped resource allocation and intra-regional welfare and equity. Offers a transferable framework for evaluating coordination policies in densely populated, resource-stressed, and climate-sensitive regions.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Wei Li (presenter), Philip Ward & Lia van Wesenbeeck, “Towards an ideal theoretical model for the water-energy-food nexus”

06/2025 Presented at the World Conference on Natural Resource Modeling, Kathmandu, Nepal.

04/2025 Presented at the **Tinbergen Institute** PhD seminar, Amsterdam, the Netherlands.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

- 01/2023-09/2023** **Project:** Comprehensive Treatment and Control Strategy of Groundwater Overexploitation
Founder: Ministry of Science and Technology of China, Peking University, and Renmin University of China
- Coordinated with local village cadres as one of team leaders
 - Participated in the household survey of seven villages in Hebei Province, China
- 01/2019-02/2021** **Project:** Short-term Forecast and Analysis of Agricultural Product Market Prices
Founder: Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Affairs of China
- Used the time series model to forecast the major agricultural products’ price in China
 - Developed the *Self-adaptable Short-term Agricultural Prices Prediction System*
 - Wrote four semi-annual reports
 - **The report of the first half of 2020 received official approval from the Deputy Secretary-General of the National Development and Reform Commission**
- 02/2019-01/2020** **Project:** Evaluation of Agricultural Modernization Level of National Modern Agricultural Demonstration Zone
Founder: Ministry of Agriculture and Rural Affairs of China
- Participated in household survey, enterprise interview, government discussion in Shanghai, Jiangsu province, and Anhui province of China
 - Calculated the agricultural modernization scores at county level based on 25 specific indicators covering six aspects
 - Drafted three comprehensive evaluation reports

TEACHING & SUPERVISING EXPERIENCE

- 08/2026-12/2026** [Fundamentals of Micro-Economics](#), Amsterdam University College, teaching assistant for Prof. [Wendy Janssens](#) and Dr. [Lia van Wesenbeeck](#)
- 02/2025-05/2025 & 02/2024-05/2024** [Advanced Macroeconomics](#), Amsterdam University College, teaching assistant for Dr. [Lia van Wesenbeeck](#)
- 04/2023-07/2023** *Bachelor Thesis Supervision*, student: Janina Krupski, thesis title: *China’s Pilot Free Trade Zones: The Solution to Avoiding the Middle-Income Trap?*
- 02/2023-03/2023** [Macroeconomics I](#), Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, teaching assistant for Dr. [Björn Brugemann](#)
- 09/2022-10/2022** [Economics Challenges](#), Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam, teaching assistant for Dr. [Roland Iwan Luttens](#)
- 03/2021-08/2021** *Principles of Economics*, Renmin University of China, teaching assistant for Prof. [Xiaohui Tian](#)

SKILLS

Computer Skills: GAMS, ArcGIS, STATA, R, Python

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Proficient), Dutch (Basic)

AWARDS & GRANTS

- 11/2025** Excellence in Teaching Award, Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam
- 07/2022-07/2025** Erasmus+ Mobility Grant-KA171, European Commission
- 09/2021-08/2025** Government-sponsored Oversea Education, China Scholarship Council
- 12/2020** First-class Academic Scholarship, Renmin University of China
- 09/2020** Excellent Paper in the 4th Agriculture, Rural Areas and Farmers Forum, editorial departments of *China Rural Economy & China Rural Observation*
- 06/2018** Honor Thesis in Management, Northwest Agriculture & Forestry University
- 11/2017** Outstanding Graduate of National Forestry Discipline, China Education Association of Forestry
- 11/2017 & 11/2016** National Scholarship (Top Honor), Ministry of Education of China (**received twice**)